

Illustration by SIDDHANT JUMDE

GLASSHOUSE

THE LOTUS BEATERS

If there's a spoiler in the BJP's vision of a 'Congress-*mukt* Bharat', it is Chhindwara in Madhya Pradesh—the Congress occupies all the crucial elected posts here. State Congress president and former chief minister Kamal Nath is an MLA from the Chhindwara assembly constituency while his son Nakul represents the seat in the Lok Sabha. The other six assembly segments in the parliamentary constituency are also in Congress hands. On July 17, Vikram Singh Ahake, the Congress candidate in Chhindwara, won the mayoral polls. The post of district panchayat president is also likely to go to Congress since it has a majority among district panchayat members. Kamal sure isn't making it easy for the *kamal* (lotus).

Mission Aborted

Goa chief minister **Pramod Sawant** inducted 28 opposition MLAs into the BJP between 2019 and 2022, the highest by any CM. However, his reputation as a 'skilled poacher' took a beating this July when he could convince only five of the 11 Congress MLAs to switch instead of the eight needed to beat the anti-defection law. Some say Sawant himself wanted Operation Lotus to fail as he did not want his critics in the BJP to swell. Sometimes you need failure to succeed in politics.



MANDAR DEODHAR

WHAT'S IN A NAME?

It's a question of identity. And so it is that the Andhra Pradesh minister for women development, child welfare and senior citizens K.V. Ushasri Charan will now be **Usha Sri Charan** in all official documents. Clarifying that she is Usha and Sri Charan her husband, the first-time YSRC MLA had applied to the chief minister's office and other relevant departments two months ago for the change in name. It had not been an issue for her till she became a minister in the Jagan Mohan Reddy cabinet in April. In 2019, YSRC Rajya Sabha member Mopidevi Venkataramana too had added Rao to his name after joining Reddy raj.





GUV VS GOVT

Telangana chief minister **K. Chandrashekar Rao** has never been happy with the governor's durbars Tamilisai Soundararajan holds for people to present their issues and then promises to bring them to the government's notice. On July 17, the two crossed paths and swords when they visited flood-ravaged Bhadradri-Kothagudem. No sooner had the governor left the shelter for the flood affected than its gates were shut and people not allowed to present their petition to the CM's convoy. The victims, who wanted the government to build houses for them, had to sit in protest on the road instead.



Hit for Six

On July 17, hours before India won the ODI against England at Old Trafford, Bihar leader of the opposition and former cricketer **Tejashwi Yadav** posted a video of him hitting sixes in the backyard of his official residence. Perhaps he was trying to shrug off the ridicule he faced after fumbling in his speech at a function attended by Prime Minister Narendra Modi in Patna on July 12. He also got flak for calling Droupadi Murmu a statue. If only he could bat political bouncers off the boundary like the cricket ball in his backyard.

–Kaushik Deka with Rahul Noronha, Kiran D. Tare, Amarnath K. Menon and Amitabh Srivastava